



Northstar Analytics Business Travel and Booking Policy

Authorization booking safety and conduct requirements for company travel

Policy owner	Finance	Version	1.0
Effective date	September 26 2026	Applies to	Employees and approved travelers

1 Purpose and Scope

Northstar Analytics supports necessary business travel while managing cost, traveler safety, client obligations, environmental impact, and operational continuity. This policy applies to employees and other travelers authorized to book or undertake travel paid or reimbursed by Northstar or a client.

Travel must have a documented business purpose and written approval before booking. Travelers must use approved booking and payment methods, select practical options, protect company and client information, and reconcile expenses under the Business Expense Reimbursement Policy.

2 Travel Authorization

The traveler must submit the purpose, destination, dates, anticipated cost, project or client code, and any personal extension or unusual requirement. The manager and budget owner confirm business need, staffing and client coverage, budget, and whether remote participation is a reasonable alternative. Finance, People Operations, Legal, Information Security, or the client owner reviews when risk or contract terms require it.

- **Domestic overnight travel.** Requires manager and budget-owner approval before booking.
- **International travel.** Requires manager, budget-owner, People Operations, and applicable Legal, Security, or client review.
- **High-risk or restricted travel.** Requires designated security and executive approval and may be prohibited.
- **Same-day local travel.** May follow standing manager approval when within an approved project or team budget.

3 Booking Requirements

Book through Northstar's designated travel channel or approved agency when available. Use the lowest reasonable total cost that meets the business schedule, including fare rules, ground transportation, baggage, change risk, traveler safety, and productive work time. Travelers must not select a preferred supplier solely to earn personal rewards when a materially better business option is available.

Travelers must provide accurate legal names and contact details, review reservations promptly, retain confirmations, and keep emergency contact and itinerary information current. Personal payment may be used only when the approved channel or company payment method is unavailable or when Finance authorizes it.

4 Air and Rail Travel

- **Cabin.** Book economy or coach. Premium economy, business, or first class requires a documented medical, accessibility, security, or exceptional business justification and advance approval.
- **Schedule.** Choose reasonable departure times and connections. A modestly higher fare may be approved to avoid unsafe, highly disruptive, or operationally impractical travel.
- **Fees.** Necessary baggage, seat assignment, and change fees may be reimbursed. Lounge access, onboard entertainment, and convenience upgrades are personal unless specifically approved.
- **Rail.** Use standard class unless an upgrade is lower cost than the reasonable air alternative or is approved for a documented need.

5 Lodging

Book a safe, business-appropriate property at a reasonable market rate near the work location. Use negotiated rates or approved properties when available. Standard rooms are required. Suites, premium views, club access, spa services, minibar purchases, in-room entertainment, and other personal amenities are not reimbursable unless required for an approved business event or accommodation.

The traveler must review taxes, resort or destination fees, internet charges, parking, and cancellation terms before booking. Alternative lodging or home-share services require advance approval and must meet safety, privacy, cancellation, and receipt requirements.

6 Ground Transportation and Personal Vehicles

Select public transit, rideshare, taxi, rental vehicle, or personal vehicle based on safety, total cost, distance, schedule, and business need. Rental vehicles should be the smallest practical class for the travelers and equipment. Optional upgrades and add-ons require approval; follow Finance instructions regarding insurance and refueling.

Use of a personal vehicle is voluntary unless the role requires it. The traveler must maintain a valid license, legally required insurance, and a safe vehicle. Reimbursement is based on the current company mileage rate for approved business miles and excludes ordinary commuting. Parking and tolls may be claimed separately; fines and violations are personal expenses.

7 Meals Incidentals and Connectivity

Reasonable meals during approved overnight travel and necessary incidentals are reimbursed under the Business Expense Reimbursement Policy. Northstar uses actual documented expenses unless Finance authorizes a per diem. Hotel internet, mobile connectivity, or workspace access is reimbursable when required for business and not otherwise available at a reasonable cost.

8 Changes Cancellations and Unused Tickets

Travelers must cancel or change reservations promptly when plans change and use available credits, refunds, or reusable tickets for future company travel. Personal-preference changes and avoidable no-show charges are not reimbursable. Weather, carrier disruption, illness, client changes, or other legitimate business circumstances should be reported to the manager and booking provider as soon as practical.

Northstar may modify or cancel travel because of business needs, budget, client direction, safety, security, health, or legal concerns. Travelers should not make nonrefundable personal commitments based on company travel plans.

9 Traveler Safety Security and Conduct

- **Safety.** Monitor official advisories, use reasonable precautions, keep emergency contacts available, and contact local emergency services first when immediate safety is at risk.
- **Information security.** Use approved devices, secure access methods, and private workspaces; protect screens, credentials, and equipment from loss, theft, inspection, or unauthorized access.
- **Conduct.** Workplace conduct, anti-harassment, confidentiality, substance-use, and client standards apply throughout company-sponsored travel and events.
- **Reporting.** Promptly report injury, illness, harassment, arrest, lost documents or equipment, security incidents, and material travel disruption to the appropriate Northstar contact.

10 International Travel

International travel requires sufficient lead time for immigration, tax, payroll, sanctions, export-control, insurance, data-access, client, and security review. The traveler must obtain required passports, visas, entry authorization, vaccinations or health documentation, and permits, and must follow local law and Northstar instructions. Northstar does not provide personal legal or tax advice.

Company-directed business travel does not authorize remote work during personal days or from another country. Any work outside approved travel dates or business activities requires separate approval under the International Remote Work Policy. Cross-border access to client or Restricted data may be limited or prohibited.

11 Personal Travel Companions and Loyalty Programs

Personal travel may be combined with business travel only when disclosed and approved before booking, it does not interfere with work, and it does not increase Northstar's cost or risk. The traveler is responsible for companion expenses, leisure days, fare differences, additional lodging, insurance, ground transportation, and change costs caused by the personal portion. Northstar is not responsible for companions.

Travelers may retain loyalty points earned on business travel if permitted by law and supplier terms, but rewards may not influence a booking contrary to this policy. Northstar does not reimburse the cash value of personal points used for business travel or costs incurred solely to earn or preserve status.

12 Travel Workflow

Step	Required action
1 Request	Submit purpose, destination, dates, estimated cost, project or client code, risks, and any personal extension.
2 Approval	Obtain manager, budget-owner, and required functional or client approvals before booking.
3 Book	Use the approved channel and payment method; select compliant transportation and lodging; retain confirmations.
4 Travel	Follow the approved itinerary, safety and conduct requirements, and promptly report significant changes or incidents.
5 Reconcile	Submit expenses, itemized receipts, currency information, credits, and explanations within the reimbursement deadline.

13 Exceptions Compliance and Related Documents

Exceptions require a documented business need, risk assessment when appropriate, and written approval from the budget owner and Finance before booking. Northstar may deny or recover noncompliant costs and may suspend booking or card privileges. Falsification or intentional misuse may result in corrective action, up to and including separation or legal action.

Related documents include the Business Expense Reimbursement Policy; International Remote Work Policy; Remote and Hybrid Work Policy; Information Security and Acceptable Use Policy; Data Classification and Handling Standard; Security Incident Reporting Procedure; Workplace Conduct and Professional Standards; and Anti-Harassment and Discrimination Policy.